position is known as straightening of fabric. The yarns must interlace at right angles.

First check if the fabric is straight by placing the fabric on long table, press with your fingers and remove the creases. Fold the fabric in the lengthwise direction. If the two selvedges meet evenly with the side of the table and the raw edges come together even with the ends of the table, then the fabric is straight. If not, straighten the fabric.

Straightening of fabric can be carried out following anyone of the processes given below :

- While buying the fabric, cut a slit at one edge of the selvedge. Hold the fabric on both hand and pull evenly, in simple terms it is similar to tearing the fabric, by doing so the fabric will tear along the cut crosswise grain which in turn will maintain the grain. This is simplest method of straightening the grain. Generally all salesmen follow tearing method, hence most of the fabric is naturally straightened.
- Draw out a crosswise thread and cut the fabric along with this thread. Place this fabric on the table and pull to meet selvedges. Pull in crosswise direction. To pull this, two person may be required. Pulling must be even on both sides. Then press the material if the cloth is wrinkled. Damp a cloth and press in lengthwise directions.
- Delicate fabric can be straightened by pressing with the fingers.

11.5 MARKING THE PAPER PATTERNS

Marking is the process of transferring the paper pattern to the garment. Great care is needed and every detail in paper pattern should be put on the fabric for cutting and sewing. The most important details are side seams, front and back cutting and sewing lines, hemlines, darts, folds, placements of pockets and fullnesses, notches, placement of openings, fasteners and any other special garment details.

What is Pouncing?

Pins are used to prick pattern design at regular intervals. The pattern is then placed on the fabric and a powdered pigment (Chalk coal for light coloured fabrics and talcum powder for dark coloured fabrics) is worked through the holes in a pouncing (tapping slowly) motion using a soft fabric pad. Thus, the pattern lies are transferred to the fabric.

The different methods followed in marking are tailor chalk, dress making's tracing wheel and carbon, pins and threads. The most commonly used methods are discussed below :

11.5.1 Tailor Chalk

Tailor chalk is a small triangular chalk which can be used to draw the outer lines of the pattern. This is cheap and commonly used. Tailors chalk is available in different colour like blue, white, yellow and red. Depending upon the colour of the fabric it can be chosen, yellow and white for dark colours and red, blue for light coloured fabrics. The main disadvantage of this method is it can't be used to transfer

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